

Word family: ****bit / bits / bitten / biting / bitty / bitwise****

****Base word:** bit**

****Plural:** bits**

****Related forms / useful extensions:** bitty, bitwise**

****Important homograph relation:** **bit** is also the past tense of ****bite****, but that belongs to a separate ****bite / bit / bitten**** verb family**

****Useful expressions:** a bit, a little bit, bit by bit, every bit, not a bit, a bit of, bits and pieces, the best/worst bit**

****Part of speech:** mainly noun (名詞) / adverb-like quantity expression (程度 / 數量用法) / technical noun (電腦術語)**

Your sentence:

> “She has a calm presence, and to me she is ****a bit like**** an old tree...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, ****a bit**** means ****slightly / somewhat / to a small degree****.

The speaker is not saying the grandmother is literally like a tree. The phrase softens the comparison:

> ****a bit like an old tree****

means:

> ****somewhat like an old tree / similar in a small figurative way****

****繁體中文:** **表示程度不高，只是有一點、某程度上；這裡用來柔化比喻，表示她「有點像」一棵老樹****

****中文翻譯:****

> “To me she is a bit like an old tree.”

「對我來說，她****有點像 / 某程度上像****一棵老樹。」

Here:

****a bit like = 有一點像；某程度上相似****

1. ****a bit = slightly / somewhat (程度) — 有點；稍微****

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “She is **a bit like** an old tree.”

「她**有點像**一棵老樹。」

Practice 2

> “I’m **a bit tired**.”

「我**有點累**。」

Practice 3

> “The room is **a bit cold**.”

「房間**有點冷**。」

a bit = 表示某種性質、狀態或程度只達到較小程度；有點 / 稍微

2. **a bit** + adjective/adverb (程度較低) — 有點.....；稍微.....

A very common grammatical pattern.

Practice 4

> “She seemed **a bit nervous**.”

「她看起來**有點緊張**。」

Practice 5

> “Can you speak **a bit more slowly**?”

「你可以說得**慢一點**嗎？」

a bit + adjective/adverb = 把程度降低或柔化，表示「稍微 / 有點」

3. **a bit like** + noun/person (有點像) — 有點像；某程度上像

This is your exact construction.

Practice 6

> “He looks **a bit like** his father.”

「他**有點像**他爸爸。」

Practice 7

> “The building is **a bit like** a castle.”

「這座建築**有點像**城堡。」

a bit like = 在某些方面相似，但並非完全一樣

4. **a bit of + noun (少量 / 一點) — 一點；少許**

Here **bit** refers to a small quantity.

Practice 8

> “I need **a bit of help**.”

「我需要**一點幫助**。」

Practice 9

> “Add **a bit of sugar**.”

「加**一點糖**。」

a bit of + noun = 少量的某種事物

Common:

* a bit of time

* a bit of luck

* a bit of advice

* a bit of water

5. **a little bit = a small amount/degree (少量 / 少許) — 一點點**

A very common variant.

Practice 10

> “Wait **a little bit**.”

「等**一會兒 / 一點點**。」

Practice 11

> “I understand **a little bit**.”

「我**懂一點點**。」

a little bit = 少量或較低程度；語氣通常比單獨 a bit 更明顯地強調「少」

6. **bit** = small piece / part (小塊 / 小部分) — 小塊；一小部分

This is the basic noun meaning.

Practice 12

> “A **bit** of paper was stuck to the table.”

「桌上黏著一**小片紙**。」

Practice 13

> “She broke the bread into small **bits**.”

「她把麵包掰成很多**小塊**。」

bit = 從較大整體中分出來的一小塊 / 一小部分

7. **bits** = small pieces/fragments (碎片) — 小塊；碎片

Practice 14

> “There were **bits** of glass on the floor.”

「地上有一些玻璃**碎片**。」

Practice 15

> “Cut the fruit into small **bits**.”

「把水果切成**小塊**。」

bits = 若干細小的碎片、部分或小塊

8. **bit** = part/section of something (部分) — 一部分 ; 一段

A broader figurative extension.

Practice 16

> “That was my favourite **bit** of the film.”

「那是整部電影中我最喜歡的**一段 / 部分**。」

Practice 17

> “I didn’t understand the last **bit**.”

「我不明白最後那**一部分**。」

bit = 某件較大事物中的一個部分、段落或片段

9. **the best/worst/funny bit** (某一段 / 部分) — 最好 / 最差 / 最好笑的部分

Practice 18

> “The best **bit** was the ending.”

「最好的一**部分**是結尾。」

Practice 19

> “The funny **bit** comes later.”

「好笑的那**一段**在後面。」

bit = 故事、影片、事件或經歷中的某個片段 / 部分

10. **bit = short period of time (短時間) — 一會兒 ; 片刻**

A common informal use.

Practice 20

> “Stay for a **bit**.”

「留下來**一會兒**吧。」

Practice 21

> “I’ll sit here for a **bit**.”

「我會在這裡坐**一會兒**。」

for a bit = 持續一小段時間 ; 一會兒

11. **wait a bit / hold on a bit (等一會) — 等一下 ; 稍等**

Practice 22

> “Wait a **bit**.”

「**等一下**。」

Practice 23

> “Can you stay a **bit** longer?”

「你可以再多留**一會兒**嗎？」

bit = 一小段時間

12. **bit by bit = gradually (逐步) — 一點一點地 ; 逐漸地**

A very useful fixed expression.

Practice 24

> “She improved **bit by bit**.”

「她**一點一點地 / 逐漸地**進步。」

Practice 25

> “The old building was repaired **bit by bit**.”

「那座舊建築**逐步**修復。」

bit by bit = 一小部分接一小部分地進行；逐漸地

13. **bits and pieces** = small miscellaneous things (零碎東西) — 零零碎碎的東西

A common idiom.

Practice 26

> “There are a few **bits and pieces** on the table.”

「桌上有一些**零零碎碎的東西**。」

Practice 27

> “I still have some **bits and pieces** to finish.”

「我還有一些**零碎事情**要完成。」

bits and pieces = 各種細小、零碎、未必彼此相同的東西 / 事情

14. **every bit** = completely / equally (完全 / 絲毫不差) — 完全；同樣地

A less obvious but useful expression.

Practice 28

> “She is **every bit as patient** as people say.”

「她**確實完全**像大家所說的一樣有耐性。」

Practice 29

> “The second version is **every bit as good** as the first.”

「第二個版本**一點也不比第一個差**。」

every bit as + adjective = 程度完全一樣；絲毫不遜色

15. **not a bit** = not at all (完全不) — 一點也不；完全不

Practice 30

> “I’m **not a bit tired**.”

「我**一點也不累**。」

Practice 31

> “She wasn’t **a bit worried**.”

「她**一點也不擔心**。」

not a bit = 完全沒有某種程度 / 狀態

This is stronger than merely:

> “not very.”

16. **a good/fair bit** = quite a lot (相當多) — 相當多；不少

Informal.

Practice 32

> “We walked **a good bit**.”

「我們走了**相當長的一段路 / 不少路程**。」

Practice 33

> “That costs **a fair bit**.”

「那個東西要花**不少錢**。」

****a good/fair bit = 相當大的數量或程度****

Interesting contrast:

> ****a bit** = a small amount**

> ****a good bit / fair bit** = quite a lot**

17. ****bit = small amount of information (資訊片段) — 一點資料 ; 片段****

Practice 34

> “I remember a few ****bits**** of the conversation.”

「我記得那段對話中的幾個****片段****。」

Practice 35

> “She gave me one useful ****bit of information****.”

「她給了我一****小段很有用的資料****。」

****bit = 一小部分資訊、內容或知識****

Common:

> bit of information

> bit of news

> bit of advice

18. ****bit = binary digit (電腦) — 位元 ; 比特****

A major technical meaning.

Practice 36

> “A ****bit**** can have a value of 0 or 1.”

「一個****位元 / bit****的值可以是 0 或 1。」

Practice 37

> “Eight **bits** make one byte.”

「八個**位元**組成一個 byte。」

bit = binary digit 的縮寫，是電腦資料最基本的二進制單位，只能表示 0 或 1

This is completely separate from “small piece” in practical modern usage, although the name historically reflects “binary digit.”

19. **bit rate / bitrate** (數碼) — 位元率；比特率

Practice 38

> “Higher audio **bit rates** can improve sound quality.”

「較高的音訊**位元率**可以改善音質。」

Practice 39

> “The video uses a lower **bitrate** to reduce file size.”

「影片使用較低的**比特率**來縮小檔案。」

bit rate = 每秒傳送或處理的位元數量

20. **bitwise** = operating on individual bits (電腦) — 位元層級的；逐位運算的

A useful technical family extension.

Practice 40

> “The program uses a **bitwise** operation.”

「這個程式使用**位元運算**。」

Practice 41

> “A **bitwise** comparison checks individual binary digits.”

「**逐位比較**會檢查個別二進制位元。」

bitwise = 對二進制資料中的每一個 bit 分別進行操作的

21. **bit = metal mouthpiece used with a horse (馬具) — 馬嚼子 ; 口銜**

A genuinely separate noun meaning.

Practice 42

> “The rider adjusted the horse’s **bit**.”

「騎手調整了馬嘴裡的**馬嚼子 / 口銜**。」

Practice 43

> “The reins are attached to the **bit**.”

「韁繩連接在**馬嚼子**上。」

bit = 放在馬口中的金屬裝置，用來透過韁繩控制馬匹

This is learner-relevant mainly for equestrian contexts.

22. **bit = cutting/drilling tool part (工具) — 鑽頭 ; 刀頭**

A common technical noun.

Practice 44

> “Use a smaller drill **bit**.”

「使用較小的**鑽頭**。」

Practice 45

> “The screwdriver **bit** needs replacing.”

「螺絲批的**批頭 / 刀頭**需要更換。」

bit = 裝在鑽機、螺絲批或其他工具上，直接接觸材料並進行切割、鑽孔或旋轉操作的部分

Common:

* drill bit

* screwdriver bit

* router bit

23. **bit = comedy/performance routine (表演片段) — 橋段 ; 小段表演**

A common entertainment use.

Practice 46

> “The comedian performed a funny **bit** about travelling.”

「那位喜劇演員表演了一段關於旅行的搞笑**橋段**。」

Practice 47

> “That **bit** always makes the audience laugh.”

「那個**表演橋段**總會令觀眾發笑。」

bit = 表演、喜劇或節目中的一小段固定內容 / 橋段

24. **do your bit = 做自己的一份 ; 盡一分力**

A common British-leaning idiom.

Practice 48

> “Everyone should **do their bit** to help.”

「每個人都應該**盡自己的一份力**。」

Practice 49

> “She did her **bit** for the community.”

「她為社區**盡了自己的一份力**。」

do your bit = 做自己應做或能力範圍內的一部分 , 為共同目標作出貢獻

25. **bitty = fragmented / made of many small disconnected parts (零碎的) — 零散的 ; 不連貫

的**

A useful related adjective, especially British English.

Practice 50

> “The presentation felt **bitty**.”

「這份簡報感覺很**零碎、不太連貫**。」

Practice 51

> “The story is interesting but rather **bitty**.”

「故事很有趣，但結構有點**零散**。」

****bitty = 由很多細小而缺乏連貫性的部分構成，令整體顯得零碎****

26. ****bit** = past tense of bite (咬了) — 咬**

This needs special handling.

In:

> “The dog ****bit**** me.”

****bit**** is ****not**** the noun/adverb-family word discussed above.

It is the irregular past tense of:

> ****bite****

Practice 52

> “The dog ****bit**** his hand.”

「那隻狗**咬了**他的手。」

Practice 53

> “She ****bit**** into the apple.”

「她**咬了一口**蘋果。」

So:

bite → **bit** → **bitten**

This should be curated under **bite**, not under the lexical family of noun **bit**.

The matching spelling is important for recognition, but the lexical families should remain distinct.

Important distinction: a bit vs a little

For degree, these often overlap.

a bit

> “I’m a bit tired.”

a little

> “I’m a little tired.”

Both:

= 「我有點累。」

A bit is especially conversational and may sound slightly more informal.

Important distinction: a bit vs slightly

a bit

informal/conversational:

> “It’s a bit expensive.”

slightly

more neutral/formal:

> “It’s slightly expensive.”

Both indicate a small degree.

Important distinction: **a bit** vs **very**

a bit tired

= 有點累

very tired

= 非常累

So **a bit** is a degree softener rather than an intensifier.

Important distinction: **a bit** vs **somewhat**

Both can mean 「有點 / 某程度上」.

a bit

more conversational.

somewhat

more formal or neutral.

> “The result is somewhat surprising.”

sounds more formal than:

> “The result is a bit surprising.”

Important distinction: **a bit like** vs **sort of like**

These overlap strongly.

a bit like

emphasizes:

> a small degree of similarity.

sort of like

often means:

> roughly/somewhat similar.

Your sentence:

> “a bit like an old tree”

is slightly cleaner and more direct than:

> “sort of like an old tree.”

Important distinction: **bit = piece vs part**

bit

usually suggests a relatively small piece/section and is often informal.

part

is completely general.

> “a bit of bread”

= a small piece

> “part of the building”

= any section

So **bit** adds the idea of smallness.

Important distinction: **bit vs piece**

piece

usually means a separate physical portion.

bit

can mean:

- * small physical piece
- * small amount
- * small section of content
- * short time
- * degree

So **bit** has a much wider informal range.

Important distinction: a bit of advice vs an advice

This is a useful learner grammar point.

Advice is normally uncountable.

So:

> **a bit of advice** ✓

> **a piece of advice** ✓

but:

> **an advice** ✗ in ordinary standard English

Here **bit** lets us quantify a small amount of an uncountable noun.

Important distinction: a bit vs bit by bit

a bit

= a small amount/degree

> “She improved a bit.”

= 她進步了一點。

bit by bit

= gradually, in small stages

> “She improved bit by bit.”

= 她一步一步地進步。

The repetition changes the meaning.

Important distinction: ****not a bit vs a bit****

****a bit worried****

= 有點擔心

****not a bit worried****

= 一點也不擔心

The negative expression is much stronger than it may first appear.

Important distinction: ****bit — computing vs byte****

****bit****

= one binary digit, 0 or 1.

****byte****

= usually eight bits.

So:

> bit ≠ byte

This is a very common learner confusion.

Important distinction: ****bit — noun vs bit — bite past tense****

This is crucial.

****a bit****

> “Wait a bit.”

= 等一會兒。

bit — past of bite

> “The dog bit me.”

= 狗咬了我。

Same spelling, completely different lexical identity.

Family-extension note

Following the reference curation style, these are especially useful members and constructions of the **bit** family:

- * **a bit — degree** = 有點 / 稍微
- * **a bit like** = 有點像
- * **a bit of + noun** = 一點 / 少許
- * **a little bit** = 一點點
- * **bit — small piece** = 小塊 / 小部分
- * **bits — fragments** = 碎片 / 小塊
- * **bit — section** = 一部分 / 一段
- * **for a bit** = 一會兒
- * **bit by bit** = 一點一點地 / 逐漸地
- * **bits and pieces** = 零碎東西
- * **every bit as...** = 完全一樣 / 絲毫不遜色
- * **not a bit** = 一點也不
- * **a fair/good bit** = 相當多
- * **bit of information/advice** = 一點資料 / 建議
- * **bit — computing** = 位元
- * **bit rate / bitrate** = 位元率
- * **bitwise** = 位元層級的 / 逐位運算的
- * **bit — horse equipment** = 馬嚼子
- * **drill/screwdriver bit** = 鑽頭 / 批頭
- * **bit — comedy/performance** = 小段表演 / 橋段
- * **do your bit** = 盡自己一分力
- * **bitty** = 零碎、不連貫的

And separately:

> **bite / bit / bitten**

should remain its own verb family rather than being merged merely because **bit** has the same

spelling.

That follows the reference method of including useful related-looking forms while preserving lexical identity accurately.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
a bit — degree	表示某種性質或狀態只達到較低程度；有點 / 稍微
a bit like	在某些方面有少量相似，但並非完全一樣
a bit of + noun	少量的某種事物
a little bit	很少量或較低程度；一點點
bit — small physical piece	從較大整體中分出來的一小塊 / 小部分
bits — fragments	若干細小的碎片、部分或小塊
bit — section	故事、影片、內容或經歷中的一個較小部分 / 片段
bit — short time	一小段時間；一會兒
bit by bit	一小部分接一小部分地進行；逐漸地
bits and pieces	各種細小、零碎、未必彼此相同的東西 / 事情
every bit as...	程度完全相同；絲毫不遜色
not a bit	完全沒有某種程度；一點也不
a fair/good bit	相當大的數量、時間或程度
bit of information/advice	一小部分資料、內容或建議
bit — computing	只能表示 0 或 1 的最基本二進制資料單位
bit rate	每秒傳送或處理的位元數量
bitwise	對每個二進制位元分別進行操作的
bit — horse equipment	放在馬口中、連接韁繩以協助控制馬匹的金屬裝置
tool bit	裝在鑽機 / 螺絲批等工具上直接進行工作的可更換部分
bit — performance	表演、喜劇或節目中的一小段內容 / 橋段
do your bit	為共同目標做自己能力範圍內應做的一部分
bitty	由很多細小而缺乏連貫性的部分構成；零碎的

For your original sentence

> “She has a calm presence, and to me she is ****a bit like**** an old tree...”

The exact meaning is:

****a bit** = 程度不高；有點 / 某程度上

Therefore:

> ****a bit like an old tree****

= **「有點像一棵老樹 / 某些方面令人聯想到一棵老樹」**

The phrase deliberately softens the metaphor.

The speaker is not saying:

> “She is exactly like an old tree.”

Instead:

> there are **some similarities**—stability, shade, calmness, endurance, support.

So this use of **bit** is the **small-degree sense**, not the physical:

> **a bit of fruit**

> = 一小塊水果

or the technical:

> **one bit of data**

> = 一個位元

or the unrelated homograph:

> **the dog bit me**

> = 狗咬了我。